A PROPOSAL FOR INDIA'S GCC ECOSYSTEM · OCTOBER 2026

Kendra

The evidence ledger for India's Global Capability Centres. Every GCC named, every number with its source.

Problem · Opportunities · Solution · Positioning + working prototype

THE ANSWER ON ONE PAGE

The data exists. Nobody has resolved it into one list.

PROBLEM

One study counts 2,117 GCCs and 3,728 centres. No report names them. Entrants, providers and states each pay a referral tax to learn what is true.

OPPORTUNITY

An entity-resolved, sourced registry of GCCs is the base layer. Signals, location intelligence and provider track records are all queries on it.

SOLUTION · POSITION

Build the ledger with AI ingestion. Sell signals to providers first; give entrants the truth free. Be the neutral record: no pay-to-rank.

THE PROBLEM · CONTEXT

A large market growing faster than its own forecasts

2,117
GCCs in India, FY26

2.36M
professionals employed

$98.4B
revenue, up from $64.6B in FY24

45%
of India's office leasing, H1 2026

About 200 new GCCs a year. The 2030 forecast of 2,100–2,200 GCCs, made in September 2024, was passed in FY26. Annual reports cannot keep up with a market that moves this fast.

Sources: Nasscom–Zinnov GCC Landscape (Sep 2024; FY26 figures as reported, May 2026); ANAROCK via IANS, Jul 2026.

THE PROBLEM · EVEN THE BASICS

Nobody agrees how many GCCs there are

Source	Date	Figure	Counts
Nasscom–Zinnov	Mid-2023	1,580	companies
Nasscom–Zinnov	Sep 2024	1,700+	companies
ANSR	2026	1,900+	GCCs
Nasscom–Zinnov	FY26	2,117	companies
Nasscom–Zinnov	FY26	3,728	physical centres
EY (forecast)	for 2030	2,400–2,550	GCCs

+76%

Gap between companies and centres in the same study. "How many GCCs" is two different questions.

None of these reports publishes the list behind its number.

Sources: Nasscom–Zinnov (2023, Sep 2024, FY26 as reported); ANSR emerging-cities report 2026; EY press release, Jun 2023.

THE PROBLEM · THE PLAYERS

One entrant, eight counterparties, no shared map

Setup advisors / Big 4

See many mandates. Sell the study, so their view is the product.

Law firms

See entity structures early. Bound by confidentiality.

Auditors and tax

See transfer pricing and real costs. Rarely shared.

Real estate firms

See space requirements months ahead. Paid on the deal.

The entrant

Makes a 5–10 year, multi-million dollar call once, with the least information of anyone.

Recruiters

See talent supply and pay. Paid per hire.

Payroll, EOR, BOT

See early-stage teams before any filing. Want the transfer later.

State governments

See MoUs and incentive claims. Compete with every other state.

Industry bodies, media

Publish aggregates. Don't publish the list.

THE PROBLEM · WHO IS HURT, HOW MUCH

Everyone pays, in different currencies

Who	What they can't see	What it costs	What they do today
New entrant	Which city and which partners actually deliver	6-month slip on 300 roles ≈ $3–4M of lost savings*	Referrals, one Big 4 study, broker tours
Service providers	Who is coming next, and when	Hear at the press release, after lease and hires are done	LinkedIn trawling, bought lists, events
State governments	Which companies to court; how they rank vs other states	Incentives aimed blind; no way to measure policy return	Consultant studies, roadshows, MoU counts
Operating GCCs	Peer benchmarks on cost, pay and scope	Mispriced talent; weak case for the next mandate	Paid surveys, peer WhatsApp groups

*Illustrative: 300 roles × ~$25k annual saving per role versus home-country cost × 0.5 year. To be validated in interviews.

THE PROBLEM · ROOT CAUSE

Data is not missing. It is unresolved.

Scattered

MCA filings, STPI and SEZ approvals, state MoUs, press, job posts, lease deals.

Unresolved

One GCC shows up under a legal entity, a brand, an acquired unit and a nickname.

Unverified

A provider's "40+ GCCs set up" looks the same as a filed lease.

Stale

Annual reports, in a market adding about four GCCs a week.

THE OPPORTUNITIES

Seven opportunities, scored on four tests

Opportunity	Who pays	Public data	Defensible	Call
GCC registry + intent signals	Providers, states	High	High	**Build first**
Location + incentive intelligence	States; free for entrants	Medium	Medium	**Build first, as the free layer**
Provider delivery records	Providers (profiles)	Low at start	Very high	Build second, on the registry
Talent and pay benchmarks	GCCs, HR	Low	Medium	Partner; crowded
Office space and clusters	Entrants, developers	Medium	Low	Ingest; brokers own it
Setup marketplace / RFPs	Providers	n/a	High once trusted	Later; needs trust first
Peer benchmarking club	GCC leaders	Contributed	High	Later

THE OPPORTUNITIES · WHAT MATTERS MOST

The registry comes first, because everything else joins on it

1

It is the base layer

Location intelligence, provider records and signals are all queries on "which GCC, where, with whom". Without resolved entities, each is one more scattered dataset.

2

It has buyers on day one

Thousands of providers need leads every month. About 200 entrants a year need the truth once. Recurring need pays the bills.

3

It compounds

Every new document makes the next match cheaper and the confidence higher. A competitor who starts later starts with less evidence.

THE SOLUTION

Kendra: one ledger, four products, one analyst

Registry and Index

Every GCC named, with a count you can audit and re-define.

Signals

Who is about to enter or expand, scored from filings, hiring and space.

Location fit

Cities ranked for a mandate, with state incentives and gaps shown.

Provider records

Deliveries linked to named GCCs by evidence, kept apart from claims.

Ask Kendra An AI analyst that calls the same tools as the products and answers only from the ledger, showing its trail.

Evidence ledger Entities, aliases, claims, sources, confidence, history. Every product reads from here.

THE SOLUTION · HOW THE LEDGER IS BUILT

AI does the reading and matching. The maths stays transparent.

1 · COLLECT
MCA filings, STPI/SEZ, state MoUs, press, job posts, leases

2 · EXTRACT
LLM turns each document into typed claims with the quote

3 · RESOLVE
Names, brands, aliases merge; low-confidence goes to review

4 · SCORE
Confidence from independent source types and recency

5 · SERVE
Products and the analyst read the same ledger

Where AI is used

Extraction from unstructured text, entity matching, signal detection in job posts, and the analyst agent that answers with tool calls.

Where it is not

Counts, confidence scores and rankings are plain formulas anyone can inspect. An LLM never invents a number that reaches a user.

THE SOLUTION · FOR WHOM FIRST

Providers pay first. Entrants get the truth free.

FIRST PAYING USER

Service providers: real estate, recruiters, EOR, law, BOT

- Need leads every week, not once
- Have budget and short buying cycles
- Tell us fast when the data is wrong

FIRST TRUSTED AUDIENCE

Entrants and GCC leaders, through a free public index

- Bring credibility and corrections
- Make a verified profile worth having
- Become the demand side of the marketplace later

THE SOLUTION · SEQUENCE AND MODEL

Three phases, each funded by the one before

When	Ship	For	Revenue
0–6 months	Ledger for the top six cities; free public GCC Index; Signals Pro	Providers	Team subscriptions
6–18 months	Location fit and incentive navigator; state benchmark dashboards	Entrants, states	State contracts; entrants free
18 months +	Provider delivery records; RFP routing; peer benchmarks	Everyone	Flat-fee verified profiles; disclosed referral fees

Pricing is a hypothesis to test in the first 30 days: a Signals seat priced against one won mandate, which for a broker or recruiter is worth far more than a year's subscription.

No revenue line pays for position. Profiles are flat-fee and ranked by evidence only.

THE POSITIONING

The record, not another report.

For anyone making a decision about India's GCCs, Kendra is the evidence ledger that names every GCC and shows the source behind every number. Unlike consultant reports, it is a list you can check. Unlike brokers and advisors, it does not sell the answer it gives.

THE POSITIONING · WHY EACH STAKEHOLDER COMES

A different reason to switch for each player

Stakeholder	Uses today	Why Kendra instead
Entrant	Referrals, one Big 4 study	A neutral shortlist of cities and partners, with evidence, in an afternoon, free
Provider	LinkedIn trawling, bought lists	Signals months before the press release, tied to the right legal entity
State government	Consultant studies, MoU counts	A live benchmark against other states and a list of companies to court
GCC leader	Paid surveys, peer chats	Peer benchmarks and a profile they can correct with evidence
Media, consultants	Their own surveys	A citable, open-method base to build on, so they can skip the counting

THE POSITIONING · THE MOAT

Neutrality is the moat, so it is written down

No pay-to-rank, ever

Providers can pay for a profile and data access. Never for a position.

Every number links to evidence

Gaps are shown as gaps. Conflicting claims stay visible.

Anyone can correct

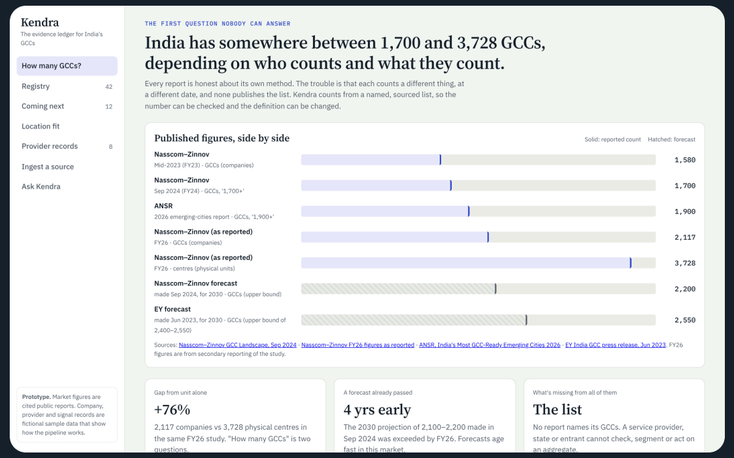
Corrections need evidence. The change log is public.

Open method

Definitions are switchable: companies or centres, with or without mid-market.

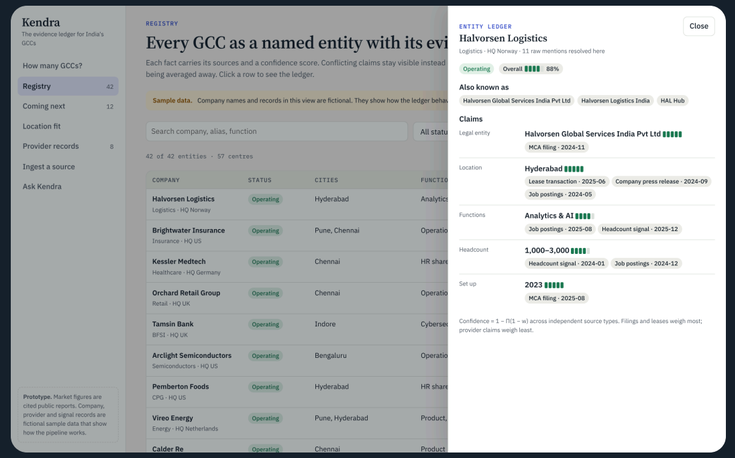
THE PROTOTYPE

It works today: seven views on one ledger



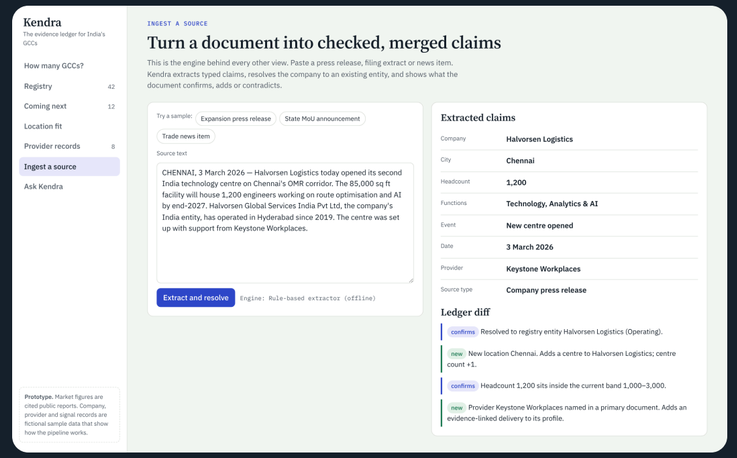
How many GCCs?

Every published figure side by side, with unit and date.



Entity ledger

Aliases, claims, sources and confidence; conflicts stay visible.



AI ingestion

Document in; claims, entity match and ledger diff out.

Also: Registry · Coming next · Location fit · Provider records · Ask Kendra. Repo: gcc/index.html. Company records are fictional sample data.

WHAT COULD BREAK THIS

Five risks, each with a 30-day test

Risk	How we'd test or contain it
Providers won't pay for signals	Hand-build 50 upcoming GCCs; sell 10 paid pilots to brokers and recruiters
Entity matching isn't accurate enough	Hand-label 500 filings and articles; publish only above 95% precision
Incumbents publish their lists	Their lists feed services they sell; neutrality and speed are hard for them to copy
Provider revenue erodes trust	Written charter, ranking separate from revenue, public change log
Data access limits	Official filings, state data and licensed feeds; no scraping behind logins

HOW THIS WAS MADE

AI for research, sparring and building; judgement on top

Research

AI web research across Nasscom–Zinnov, EY, ANSR, ICRA, ANAROCK and state policy notes. Every figure in the deck kept with its source; conflicts kept, not smoothed.

Sparring

Opportunities scored against four tests and argued both ways. The "data is unresolved, not missing" reframe came from noticing the 2,117 vs 3,728 gap.

Building

Prototype built with Claude and run on Claude: extraction to typed claims, and a tool-using analyst. Deterministic maths wherever a number reaches a user.

NEXT

Every number, with its source.

First step: a 30-day sprint. Hand-build the ledger for 50 upcoming GCCs, sell 10 provider pilots, and measure matching precision on 500 labelled records.